AWESOME CYBER SECURITY HEAVEN · REALM DOSSIER · 2026 EDITION

The Vault

Secrets, Credentials & Password Security Tools

18	253,655	89%	15
FREE TOOLS	COMBINED STARS	ON GITHUB	ACTIVE IN 2026

18 tools · ← Back to the main list · Data verified **2026-10-22** (re-verified monthly)

CURATOR'S NOTES

Credential hygiene: secret scanners, live-secret verifiers, password audit corpora and hash oracles. We deliberately list no credential-attack or cracking-delivery tools — the line between auditing and attacking credentials is a policy, not an accident.

MAINTENANCE SNAPSHOT (2026-10-22)

- Active in the last 30 days: 10 of 16 tracked GitHub repos (63%)
- Quiet classics (no push in 12+ months, still listed): LaZagne
- Earliest entries: John the Ripper (2011), LaZagne (2015), HashiCorp Vault (2015)

Part of Awesome Cyber Security Heaven — 520 curated free tools across 14 realms

FLAGSHIP PICKS — THE HEAVYWEIGHTS

TOOL	★ STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	WHAT IT DOES
HashiCorp Vault	36.4k	2015	2026-10-21 ✅	A tool for secrets management, encryption as a service, and privileged access management
gitleaks	30.2k	2018	2026-09-30 ✅	Find secrets with Gitleaks 🔑
KeePassXC	29.4k	2016	2026-10-21 ✅	KeePassXC is a cross-platform community-driven port of the Windows application “KeePass Password Safe”.
trufflehog	28.6k	2016	2026-10-22 ✅	Find, verify, and analyze leaked credentials
hashcat	27k	2015	2026-10-21 ✅	World's fastest and most advanced password recovery utility
age	24k	2019	2026-08-29	A simple, modern and secure encryption tool (and Go library) with small explicit keys, no config options, and…

FULL INVENTORY — 18 CURATED TOOLS

ranked by GitHub adoption · 2026-10-22 census · non-GitHub entries listed last

TOOL	★ STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE / TIER
HashiCorp Vault	36.4k	2015	2026-10-21 ✅	— the enterprise secrets platform: dynamic credentials, PKI, encryption-as-a-service. Used by platform teams managing secrets at scale; the open-source alternative to cloud secret stores and CyberArk for dynamic secrets. (source-available BSL)
gitleaks	30.2k	2018	2026-09-30 ✅	— fast git-history secret scanning from pre-commit hooks to CI; the default choice for repos. Used by DevSecOps teams scanning repos for secrets in CI; the open-source alternative to GitGuardian's paid platform.

TOOL	★ STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE / TIER
KeePassXC	29.4k	2016	2026-10-21 ✅	— cross-platform, offline, no-cloud password manager — the security-community standard. Used by security-conscious professionals storing credentials offline; the community alternative to 1Password and LastPass. (GPL-3.0)
trufflehog	28.6k	2016	2026-10-22 ✅	— deep secret scanning across git, S3, Docker images and 800+ detector types with live credential verification. Used by security teams hunting leaked secrets across git history and object stores; the open-source alternative to commercial secret-scanning services. (AGPL-3.0)
hashcat	27k	2015	2026-10-21 ✅	— the world's fastest password-recovery tool; the standard for authorized password-strength audits. Used by password auditors and DFIR teams worldwide; the cracker commercial rigs also run.
age	24k	2019	2026-08-29	— simple, modern, opinionated file-encryption tool for the post-GPG era. Used by developers wanting simple, modern file encryption; the spiritual successor to GPG for the gitops era.
SOPS	23.5k	2015	2026-10-20 ✅	— encrypted secrets in git: edit YAML/JSON values, commit ciphertext, rotate keys. Used by DevOps teams encrypting secrets inside config repos; the open standard for gitops-friendly secret management. (MPL-2.0)
Bitwarden	20.4k	2015	2026-10-22 ✅	— open-source, sync-everywhere password management for teams and families. Used by teams and individuals wanting open-source password management; the self-hostable alternative to commercial password SaaS. (AGPL + commercial options)
John the Ripper	13.8k	2011	2026-10-11 ✅	— the classic password auditor: hundreds of hash formats and the legendary jumbo community build. Used by password auditors for three decades; the classic open-source cracker no pentest kit ships without. (GPL-2.0)
LaZagne	11k	2015	2025-09-18 ⏳	— audits which passwords your workstations remember — browsers, mail clients, OS stores — for authorized inventory and exposure checks only. Used by pentesters in authorized engagements demonstrating credential exposure on compromised hosts; the classic credential-harvesting tool. (LGPL-3.0)
detect-secrets	4.7k	2017	2026-04-02	— enterprise secret scanner designed for baseline diffs and incremental CI audits. Used by CI pipelines baseline-scanning for secrets; Yelp's open scanner that complements commercial enterprise offerings.
hardened_malloc	2k	2018	2026-10-21 ✅	— the allocator that makes exploitation harder by design; from the GrapheneOS project. Used by hardened deployments and privacy distros for exploit-mitigating memory allocation; the open allocator adopted by GrapheneOS-class systems. (MIT)
Kingfisher	1.3k	2025	2026-10-20 ✅	— MongoDB's open-source Rust secret scanner: detect leaked secrets across code/Git/history/containers/cloud, then live-validate credentials, map blast radius and revoke — the full post-detection lifecycle. Used by security teams killing the "leaked-but-rotated key" false-positive class; embeddable as CLI, Rust lib or Python SDK. (Apache-2.0)
keyFinder	726	2019	2026-07-19	— passively discovers leaked API keys and secrets in web pages during browsing. Used by forensic analysts locating crypto key material in memory images; the niche free utility for DFIR work. (MIT)
Retraced (BoxyHQ)	451	2016	2026-08-07	— open-source audit-log API: compliant, tamper-evident activity records for your SaaS. Used by SaaS builders adding compliance-grade audit logging; the open-source alternative to commercial audit-log services. (Apache-2.0)
siloscan	-	2026	2026-09-12	— offline air-gapped repository secret and code-quality scanner with 228 rules and SARIF output; zero telemetry. Used by teams scanning sensitive repositories where nothing may leave the network; the air-gap-friendly secret scanner for restricted environments. (MIT)

TOOL	★ STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE / TIER
Databunker	—	—	—	— encrypted personal-data vault: API-first storage for PII with built-in privacy compliance. Used by backend teams storing customer PII encrypted and auditable; the open-source alternative to commercial customer-data vaults. (GPL-3.0)
MAT2	—	—	—	— Metadata Anonymisation Toolkit v2: strips hidden metadata from documents, images and more. Used by journalists and privacy-conscious users stripping metadata from documents; the free alternative to commercial redaction suites. (GPL-3.0)